The Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity

Relativistic Recovery

Abstract

This paper states how Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the exact-closure theory of Æther / Æther-flow framework, recovers established relativistic physics. The scope is explicit. The manuscript does not claim a first-principles substrate derivation of relativity from Æther variables. It analyzes the adopted effective theory already fixed in the Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity dynamics manuscript: Einsteinian gravity with universal matter coupling and a single operational metric.

With that scope fixed, the recovery statement is also explicit. The exact relation of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity to general relativity is identity at the effective predictive level. The weak-field, causal, redshift, clock, and local inertial structures are therefore exactly those of GR. Local special-relativistic kinematics are recovered in the ordinary way through local inertial frames and Lorentz symmetry of the tangent-space metric. The Æther / Æther-flow ontology is retained only as deeper interpretation and is not promoted, in Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, to an extra low-energy preferred-frame field. In that precise sense, Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity functions as a disciplined interpretive completion consistent with exact GR, not as a non-GR relativistic deformation.

Within the flagship exact-closure package, the overview is the front door, the *Exact-Closure Note* is the short anchor, and the present paper is the relativistic-recovery module of the five-paper modular full statement. Its job is to make the observer-facing GR/SR content explicit after the exact law and its consistency have already been fixed. That order keeps exact closure first and derivational continuation secondary.

1. Introduction

The current manuscript sequence fixes the scientific role of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity clearly. Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is the exact-closure, GR-consistent theory developed in the active repository. It is the exact reference for any later extension of the framework. The dynamics manuscript already fixed the adopted effective law. The consistency manuscript already made explicit that the effective exact-closure theory is mathematically healthy. The remaining question is therefore observer-facing: how does Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity recover the relativistic structure that actual observers measure?

That question has two parts. First, the exact relation to GR has to be stated in disciplined language. Second, the relation to SR has to be addressed explicitly rather than left implicit. The latter point matters because the ontology of Æther and Æther-flow can easily be misunderstood as if it implied a measurable preferred frame. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, that is not the operative theory statement.

Framework and claim boundary. Æther / Æther-flow framework denotes the broader Æther / Æther-flow framework built on the claims that the Æther is the underlying four-dimensional substrate of reality, the Æther-flow is its intrinsic ordered motion, observed three-dimensional space is the local experiential slice of that deeper substrate, S-time is the experienced order of change arising from matter, light, and the Æther-flow, and observed expansion is the three-dimensional appearance of deeper four-dimensional ordered motion. Within that framework, Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity denotes the exact-closure theory in which the effective gravitational dynamics are adopted to be exactly Einsteinian with universal matter coupling. In the active sequence, *adoption* means use of that established relativistic dynamics without claiming substrate derivation, while *derivation* is reserved for a first-principles recovery from explicit substrate variables.

Definition 1 (Exact relativistic recovery)**.** *Exact relativistic recovery in Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity means that the effective operational content of the theory reproduces the accepted GR/SR structure exactly in the domains where that structure is tested, while the Æther / Æther-flow ontology is retained as deeper interpretation rather than as an extra low-energy propagating sector.*

The sequence role of the present manuscript should therefore be read explicitly. After the overview, the short exact-closure anchor, and the foundations, dynamics, and consistency modules, this paper states how that already-adopted and already-checked exact law is recovered in weak-field, causal, clock, and local inertial terms. The remaining flow-geometry paper then sharpens the interpretive dictionary inside the same closure.

2. Exact Relation to General Relativity

The adopted Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity action is

$$S_{\text{eff}} = \frac{c^3}{16\pi G} \int d^4x \sqrt{-g}\, R + S_{\text{matter}}[g, \psi], \tag{1}$$

with field equations

$$G_{\mu\nu} = \frac{8\pi G}{c^4} T_{\mu\nu}. \tag{2}$$

Matter is minimally and universally coupled to the same metric $g_{\mu\nu}$.

Proposition 1 (Operational identity with GR)**.** *For fixed matter sector, initial data, and boundary conditions, every effective observable of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity coincides with the corresponding observable of GR.*

This statement is precise and should not be weakened into mere analogy. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, GR is not only approximately matched in some restricted regime. It is adopted exactly as the effective gravitational law. Therefore:

$$\mathcal{O}_{\text{theory}} = \mathcal{O}_{\text{GR}} \tag{3}$$

for every observable $\mathcal{O}$ defined entirely within the effective metric/matter sector.

Remark 1. *Equation* (3) *is an adoption statement, not a derivation statement. The paper does not claim that the Einstein sector has already been recovered from explicit substrate microphysics.*

The proper scientific reading is therefore the following. Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity is not a rival low-energy alternative to GR. It is a disciplined interpretive completion of the relativistic sector within Æther / Æther-flow framework, and a proposed deeper ontology consistent with GR, with no independent non-GR prediction at the effective level.

3. Weak-Field Recovery

In an asymptotically inertial region one writes

$$g_{\mu\nu} = \eta_{\mu\nu} + h_{\mu\nu}, \qquad |h_{\mu\nu}| \ll 1. \tag{4}$$

In the static, slowly moving regime with $T_{00} \simeq \rho c^2$ dominant, the leading field equation reduces to

$$\nabla^2 \Phi = 4\pi G \rho. \tag{5}$$

The weak-field line element then takes the standard form

$$ds^2 = -\left(1 + 2\frac{\Phi}{c^2} + O(c^{-4})\right) c^2 dt^2 + \left(1 - 2\frac{\Phi}{c^2} + O(c^{-4})\right) \delta_{ij}\, dx^i dx^j. \tag{6}$$

Equivalently, in standard post-Newtonian language the Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity theory carries the GR values of the metric-sector parameters. In particular,

$$\gamma_{\mathrm{PPN}} = 1, \tag{7}$$

and, more generally, the full PPN content of the theory is that of GR because the effective theory is exactly GR.

For slowly moving test bodies, the geodesic equation reduces to

$$\frac{d^2 x^i}{dt^2} = -\partial_i \Phi + \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{v^2}{c^2}, \frac{\Phi^2}{c^4}\right), \tag{8}$$

which is the ordinary Newtonian limit.

Corollary 1 (Weak-field observables)**.** *The weak-field observables of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, including Newtonian acceleration, post-Newtonian light deflection, and Shapiro time delay, are exactly the corresponding GR observables.*

This corollary is immediate from the exact-closure rule. The theory does not require a second matching prescription once the effective law has already been fixed.

4. Light Propagation and Causal Structure

The operational role of light is governed by the single effective metric. Null propagation satisfies

$$0 = g_{\mu\nu}\, dx^\mu dx^\nu, \tag{9}$$

and null rays follow the geodesic equation

$$k^\nu \nabla_\nu k^\mu = 0, \tag{10}$$

for wave-vector k^μ.

Proposition 2 (Single-metric causal structure)**.** *In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the causal structure relevant to low-energy observation is exactly the causal structure of the metric $g_{\mu\nu}$. There is no second universal low-energy cone and no extra preferred-frame light-propagation sector.*

This proposition matters directly for how the ontology should be read. The Æther / Æther-flow language is not being used here to introduce an additional low-energy propagation law for light. In the exact-closure theory, light propagation, causal ordering, and gravitational time delay are all controlled by the same metric null cone already present in GR.

At every event p, one may choose local inertial coordinates such that

$$g_{\mu\nu}(p) = \eta_{\mu\nu}, \qquad \partial_\alpha g_{\mu\nu}(p) = 0. \tag{11}$$

In those coordinates,

$$ds^2 = -c^2 dt'^2 + \delta_{ij}\, dx'^i dx'^j + O((x' - p)^2). \tag{12}$$

Hence null propagation satisfies

$$\left| \frac{d\vec{x}'}{dt'} \right| = c \tag{13}$$

locally, exactly as in SR.

5. Redshift and Time-Dilation Structure

To state gravitational redshift cleanly, write a static metric in the form

$$ds^2 = -N^2(\mathbf{x})\, c^2 dt^2 + \gamma_{ij}(\mathbf{x})\, dx^i dx^j. \tag{14}$$

For a stationary observer with $dx^i = 0$,

$$d\tau = N(\mathbf{x})\, dt. \tag{15}$$

Thus clocks at different positions accumulate different proper times relative to the same static coordinate time.

For light emitted at A and received at B by stationary observers in the static geometry (14), the frequency ratio is

$$\frac{\nu_B}{\nu_A} = \frac{N(\mathbf{x}_A)}{N(\mathbf{x}_B)}. \tag{16}$$

In the weak-field regime where

$$N(\mathbf{x}) = 1 + \frac{\Phi(\mathbf{x})}{c^2} + O(c^{-4}), \tag{17}$$

this becomes

$$\frac{\nu_B - \nu_A}{\nu_A} = \frac{\Phi_A - \Phi_B}{c^2} + O(c^{-4}). \tag{18}$$

These are the ordinary GR redshift relations, inherited exactly by Æther-flow Interpretation of

Relativity. The same is true for proper-time accumulation along arbitrary timelike histories:

$$d\tau^2 = -\frac{1}{c^2} g_{\mu\nu}\, dx^\mu dx^\nu. \tag{19}$$

Two time-dilation mechanisms are therefore present in the familiar relativistic way.

1. Gravitational time dilation arises through position dependence of the metric, as in (15)–(18).
2. Kinematic time dilation arises locally from motion relative to an inertial frame, as discussed in the next section.

6. Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity and Special Relativity

6.1. Local Recovery of SR

Equation (12) already states the local SR limit. In any sufficiently small neighborhood of an event, nongravitational physics is governed by the Minkowski metric $\eta_{\mu\nu}$. Local Lorentz transformations preserve that tangent-space metric and therefore preserve the usual SR interval.

For a timelike observer moving with speed v in a local inertial frame,

$$d\tau = dt'\sqrt{1 - \frac{v^2}{c^2}} = \frac{dt'}{\gamma_{\mathrm{L}}}, \qquad \gamma_{\mathrm{L}} \equiv \frac{1}{\sqrt{1 - v^2/c^2}}. \tag{20}$$

Accordingly, the standard SR kinematic consequences follow locally: time dilation, relativity of simultaneity, and the usual Lorentz contraction rule $L = L_0/\gamma_{\mathrm{L}}$ when lengths are compared within the same local inertial construction.

Proposition 3 (Explicit SR relation)**.** *The exact-closure theory Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity reproduces the operational content of special relativity locally, because the observer-accessible metric structure is locally Minkowskian and matter/light couple only to that structure.*

6.2. Why the Ontology Does Not Contradict SR

The most important conceptual clarification is negative. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the Æther and Æther-flow are not introduced as extra measured low-energy structures that override local Lorentz symmetry. The theory does not add a second matter metric, a preferred-frame vector field, or an observable anisotropic light cone. Had it done so, it would not be exact closure; it would be a deviation theory.

This is why the ontology and SR do not conflict in the exact-closure reading. SR is the operational local kinematics seen by observers. The Æther / Æther-flow vocabulary is the deeper interpretive proposal about what the effective relativistic order may describe. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the two levels are distinct:

1. operational level: local measurements obey SR;
2. effective gravitational level: spacetime structure obeys GR;
3. ontological level: the relativistic order is interpreted as the observer-accessible manifestation of deeper Æther organization.

6.3. S-Time, Measured Duration, and Observed Spatial Relations

The relation to S-time should also be stated carefully. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, S-time is not a replacement variable for proper time τ, coordinate time t, or the metric causal order. It is the interpretive name for experienced order of change as registered by material systems and light within the exact relativistic structure.

Quantitatively, measured duration along a timelike worldline is still given by proper time (19). Observed three-dimensional spatial relations for an observer with four-velocity u^μ are encoded by the local rest-space metric

$$h_{\mu\nu} = g_{\mu\nu} + \frac{1}{c^2} u_\mu u_\nu. \tag{21}$$

This is the precise sense in which the theory can speak of observed three-dimensional space as a local experiential slice. The observer-accessible slice is not a second physical geometry competing with relativity; it is the ordinary observer rest-space determined by the same effective metric.

Remark 2. *In the exact-closure theory, S-time and observed space therefore do not modify relativity. They reinterpret the experienced temporal and spatial order already quantified by proper time, causal structure, and observer rest-space geometry.*

7. Scope of the Present Recovery Statement

The present paper makes one positive claim and keeps one deeper task open. The positive claim is that, in Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, the observer-accessible relativistic sector is exactly the GR/SR sector: the same metric governs clocks, light, free fall, weak-field phenomena, and local inertial physics. The open task is the deeper recovery problem, namely, how that exact relativistic structure should ultimately be obtained from explicit substrate dynamics rather than adopted as the effective law.

This scope should not be read as retreat. It is precisely what allows Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity to function as a positive interpretive completion of relativity rather than as an unfinished competing deformation of it.

8. Benchmark Role and Explicit Nonclaims

Within the flagship package, the present manuscript is the observer-facing recovery module of the benchmark theory. Its positive role is to make the following points explicit.

1. One operative metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ governs clocks, light propagation, free fall, weak-field observables, and local inertial structure.

2. Matter remains universally coupled to that same metric, so the observer-accessible relativistic sector is exactly the GR/SR sector.

3. The Æther / Æther-flow ontology is preserved only as deeper interpretation of that exact relativistic structure, not as a second low-energy dynamics.

The manuscript also has explicit nonclaims that are part of the benchmark package discipline.

1. It does not derive the operative metric or the Einsteinian observer law from explicit substrate variables.

2. It does not introduce a second operative metric, a second universal causal cone, a preferred-frame matter coupling, or an independent low-energy non-GR observable sector.

3. It does not replace the foundations, dynamics, or consistency modules; it presupposes them and states the exact observer-facing recovery that follows once those benchmark ingredients are fixed.

Read in that role, the manuscript closes the observer-level part of the claim boundary before the sequence turns to the flow-geometry dictionary. It therefore strengthens the benchmark package without reopening the adoption/derivation distinction.

9. Conclusion

This paper completes the relativistic-recovery step for the exact-closure reading of Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity. The relation to GR is explicit: the effective observable content of the theory is identical to that of GR. The weak-field limit, Newtonian reduction, light propagation, causal structure, redshift, and gravitational time dilation are therefore inherited exactly. The relation to SR is also explicit: local inertial frames recover the Minkowski interval, local Lorentz symmetry, the standard kinematic time-dilation law, and the standard observer-level spatial relations.

The conceptual point is equally important. The Æther / Æther-flow ontology is not being used here to deny or deform relativity. In Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity, it is used only as a deeper interpretive layer beneath an exact GR/SR operational structure. That is why the theory can serve as the exact reference and fallback statement for the wider Æther / Æther-flow program while remaining fully compatible with established relativistic physics. In the flagship sequence, this recovery module is read after the consistency paper and before the flow-geometry paper, so that exact closure is first stated and recovered at observer level before any secondary derivational continuation is considered.

10. Final Naming Statement

With the foundations, dynamics, consistency, and relativistic-recovery sequence now drafted, the naming choice can follow the theory structure rather than precede it.

The active public name is Æther-flow Interpretation of Relativity. That name should be used directly in titles, opening paragraphs, and repository notes. Older labels from earlier repository stages are historical only and should not be used in the active manuscript sequence.

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